Q+A

HUNGRY FOR MORE

Bad health might have kept him from our screens for a bit, but the 71-year-old **Mithun Chakraborty** is now doing it all—making a digital debut, readying a new film, even judging a reality TV show

Q. What got you interested in Amazon Prime's *Bestsellers*?
I play a police officer but not a regular one. His character is quite interesting because he is very unpredictable. While he is really good at his job, he doesn't seem to take it seriously. He is also a foodie, who is constantly talking about food and even has his own food channel. He is so obsessed with food that in the middle of an investigation, he starts talking about some dish or where to get the best sweets in the city from. At the same time, he is absolutely ruthless.

Q. You love cooking in real life too, right?
Yeah. Cooking has been a lifelong hobby. I think I make really good Indian food. The only other cuisine I cook is Chinese but I am not very good at it.

Q. You've done almost 370 films. Do you still get nervous when you start a new acting project?
I don't get nervous, but I am definitely aware that it is a new cast and crew I will be working with. It does take a day or two for everyone to settle in. I am a very easy actor to have on set and I like having a friendly vibe around me. I crack jokes and get friendly with everyone so that they stop thinking of me as a senior actor or being in awe of me, because that will show up on screen.

Q. The industry has transformed in many ways since you made your debut 46 years ago. Is there a change that you wish had happened during your heydays?
During the '80s and '90s, casting me or any hero in a film meant it had to have five great songs, five action sequences and some heavy-duty dialogues. There was a formula. But today, even the most popular of heroes plays really interesting characters. They really get to explore different characters. This is what gives an actor's career longevity.

—with Karishma Upadhyay

